

# HOW COMMUNITIES CAN STOP DESTRUCTIVE DEVELOPMENT PROJECTS IN SOMALIA

## *Complete Community Opposition How-To*

### INTRODUCTION & FRAMEWORK

Concern for the environment in Somalia must be pursued with great care and largely through the international, the diaspora, and the community, because this is a fragile, conflict-affected state where an armed insurgency contests the countryside, enforcement is weak, and environmental work carries real danger. Somalia is a Horn of Africa nation with one of the continent's longest coastlines, and its environmental story is defined by three interlocking harms of a kind found almost nowhere else in this series. Somalia is a Horn of Africa nation with one of the continent's longest coastlines and a semi-arid interior of acacia woodland and rangeland, and its environmental story is defined by three interlocking harms of a kind found almost nowhere else in this series. The first is the charcoal trade: the felling of the acacia woodlands for charcoal, the main driver of a deepening deforestation and desertification, and — notoriously — a taxed source of revenue for the armed insurgency, banned by the United Nations yet continuing still. The second is the plundering of the sea: the foreign fleets that have illegally fished one of Africa's longest coastlines, and the hazardous and toxic waste dumped off it, in the vacuum left when the state collapsed — the very injuries that once drove coastal communities to desperation. The third is the drought: the recurrent, deepening droughts and famines that degrade the land and drive desperate people into the very charcoal trade that worsens them. The third is the drought: the recurrent, deepening droughts and famines that degrade the land, ruin the pastoralist livelihoods, and drive desperate people into the very charcoal trade that worsens them. This guide will be honest that the charcoal trade is bound up with the conflict, so confronting it is dangerous and cannot be done by enforcement alone; that the plundering of the sea is foreign-driven and exploits a state that cannot yet defend its own waters; that the drought is severe and climate-driven; that the political space is fragile and parts of the country are contested and perilous, so the work must run through international, diaspora, and community channels and protect anyone inside absolutely; and that no landmark victory is to be won; but it will show that the levers here — the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the international frameworks — are real, and can be used, with care.

The Somali story teaches two things about opposing destructive harms here, and this guide states both plainly. The first is the pattern that runs through every guide: not a single silver bullet, but the combination of every lever pressed together. The second is distinctly Somali, and it is what gives this guide its particular force. **Because the charcoal trade is banned by the world and reaches identifiable foreign markets, because the illegal fishing and the toxic dumping are foreign harms the international frameworks can reach, because the drought demands adaptation and alternative livelihoods the world supports, because the coast can be defended through conservation, and because the international bodies, the diaspora, and the rebuilding state offer real channels, the levers run through the international and the community: the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks.** That combination — the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks — is the distinctive lever here, and this guide is built around it, because in a fragile, conflict-affected state, the strongest ground is the international frameworks that reach the charcoal markets and the foreign fleets, the alternatives that break the desperate cycle, and the diaspora and community that act where the state cannot.

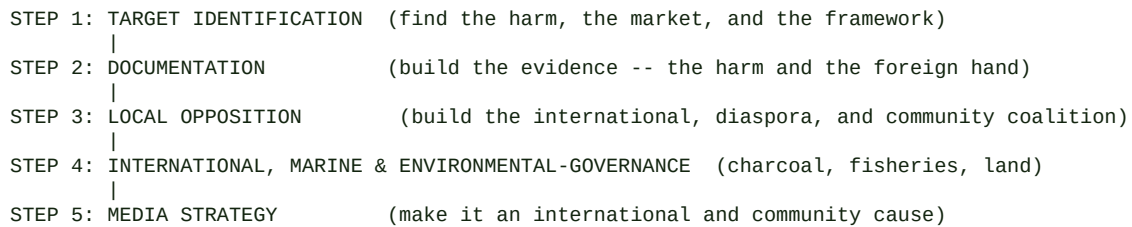
But the same story carries honest qualifications this guide states plainly and takes seriously. **The charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered from abroad, the drought is severe, the state fragile, and no victory final.** The charcoal trade is entangled with the insurgency and with the desperation of impoverished people, so it cannot be ended by enforcement alone but only by alternatives and international pressure on the markets; the illegal fishing and dumping are foreign-driven and exploit a state too weak to police its waters; the drought is recurrent and worsening; the state is fragile and parts of the country contested, so the work must be international, diaspora-borne, community-based, and protective of anyone inside; and no landmark victory is to be pointed to. This guide does not pretend the charcoal is simple, or that the state can yet defend its seas, or that the drought can be quickly undone. What it shows is how, through the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks, those who care — in the international bodies, the large diaspora, the local communities where it is safe, and the rebuilding institutions — can defend the woodlands, the fisheries, and the land, carefully, within the space that exists, and protecting anyone inside absolutely.

Most people who care about Somalia's environment do not know HOW to use the levers a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state offers. They see the woodlands felled, the charcoal shipped, the foreign trawlers offshore, the waste washed ashore, the land parched — and either despair of a broken state, or imagine an enforcement that the state cannot yet deliver, and rarely grasp the levers that work: the international charcoal ban and the pressure on its markets, the international maritime and fisheries frameworks, the alternative livelihoods, the diaspora, the community. The gap between the woodland defended and the woodland felled is here often a gap of method — the method of using the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks together, carefully.

**This guide shows what can actually be tried — inside the Somali reality as it is, which is a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered Horn of Africa state.** It is written for the person — in the international community, in the large Somali diaspora, in a coastal or rural community where it is safe, or in the rebuilding institutions — who sees the woodlands and the seas and the land harmed and wants to know what can be done in a fragile and dangerous nation. The answer is a qualified yes: the levers are real — the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks — with the honest qualifiers that the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered from abroad, the drought severe, the state fragile, and no victory final, so the work is international, diaspora-borne, community-based, careful, and protective of anyone inside, not open confrontation. A note on who this guide is for, and on the spirit in which it should be used, because the Somali case is particular and demands great care. It is for the person — in the international community, in the large Somali diaspora, in a coastal or rural community where it is entirely safe, or in the rebuilding institutions — willing to do the patient, external, and protective work of defending the woodlands and seas and land through the world's international channels, rather than either despairing of a broken state or attempting the open domestic confrontation that a conflict-affected state forecloses. That is not a lesser ambition but, for a fragile and conflict-affected state, the only responsible and effective one, because here the levers that genuinely deliver are the world's charcoal ban and markets, the maritime frameworks that reach the foreign fleets, the climate and humanitarian frameworks that restore the land, and the alternatives that break the desperate cycle, all of which are reached from outside, and none of which requires — or should ever risk — the dangerous exposure of anyone inside. Anyone who imagines that open domestic confrontation is the path may endanger the very people they mean to help; anyone who works patiently and protectively through the international channels, the markets, the alternatives, and the diaspora, from outside, can genuinely help defend a worn land's woodlands and seas. This guide is an honest map of that external, protective path.

## **The Strategic Framework**

Effective efforts follow the same underlying pattern, adapted to a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state:



These steps operate **simultaneously, not in sequence**. The evidence of the harm and its foreign or market dimension feeds the charcoal case, the fisheries defence, and the land restoration at once; the international, diaspora, and community coalition organises; an international appeal, a market pressure, or an alternative-livelihood effort is both pressure and a spur to the next. The effort that runs all five together, each reinforcing the others, gives itself the best — if still constrained — chance of defending the woodlands, the fisheries, and the land.

## The Levers That Are Distinctly Strong Here

Every country's system has its own pressure points. Somalia's — a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state — give a distinctive set:

- **The charcoal.** The **charcoal trade** is banned by the world and reaches identifiable foreign markets that can be pressed — the distinctive lever.
- **The fisheries.** The **illegal foreign fishing and the toxic dumping** are foreign harms the international maritime frameworks can reach.
- **The land.** The **drought and desertification** demand adaptation and alternative livelihoods the world supports.
- **The coast.** The **coast and its mangroves** can be defended through conservation and community management.
- **The frameworks.** The **international bodies, the diaspora, and the rebuilding state** offer real channels a fragile state's own enforcement cannot.

## What This Guide Will Not Pretend

It would be dishonest to promise these levers prevail, or that the state can yet enforce, or that the charcoal is simple. The charcoal **funds the conflict**; the sea is **plundered from abroad**; the drought is **severe**; the state is **fragile**; and no victory is **final**. This guide takes those limits seriously — it states them plainly, and it works through the international, the diaspora, and the community while protecting anyone inside — and shows how to use the real tools this situation offers — the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks — to defend the woodlands, the fisheries, and the land, honestly acknowledging the charcoal-and-conflict entanglement, the foreign plundering, the severe drought, and the absence of a final victory.

## HOW THE SYSTEM WORKS

You cannot pull a lever you cannot see — and here you must see that the levers run largely through the international, the diaspora, and the community, because in a fragile, conflict-affected state where an insurgency contests the countryside and the state cannot yet police its own land and waters, open domestic

confrontation is perilous, and the charcoal markets, the foreign fleets, and the international frameworks are reached from outside and through those who can act safely. Before you spend a single week, map who actually decides a harm's fate, at which level, and where the leverage is real. And map where the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks apply, because in Somalia a destructive harm is met not by open protest, which is dangerous, but by pressing the international frameworks, the markets, and the alternatives, carefully.

## The Levels of Decision

A Somali environmental harm runs through a fragile, contested, and internationally-entangled system.

**The federal and state authorities.** The **federal government, the federal member states, and, in the north, Somaliland's own institutions** hold the mandate, though their enforcement is weak and their reach contested.

**The international bodies and frameworks.** The **United Nations, its environmental and monitoring bodies, and the international bans and maritime frameworks** are where the charcoal and the foreign fleets are most reachable.

**The market and foreign actors.** The **foreign markets that buy the charcoal, the foreign fleets that fish the waters, and the dumpers** are the harms' true drivers, reachable through international pressure.

**The diaspora and community.** The **large Somali diaspora and the local communities** hold voice and knowledge and can act where the state cannot and where it is safe.

**The regional and international partners.** The **regional bodies, the European and other partners, and the humanitarian and climate frameworks** carry the cooperation and support a fragile state needs.

## The Journey of a Harm

A Somali harm — the felling of a woodland for charcoal, a foreign trawler in the waters, waste dumped off the coast, land parched by drought — is met through the **charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks**. **The charcoal and the fisheries are where the distinctive harms are met, and the land and the coast are where the country is restored** — and using them together, through the international and the community, is the distinctive Somali approach. The distinctive levers are the **charcoal**, the **fisheries**, the **land**, the **coast**, and the **frameworks**. Find out exactly where the harm stands, and, crucially, **what woodland, fishery, or land is at stake, what market or foreign hand drives it, and how the international frameworks, the diaspora, and the community can act**, because those are where a harm can genuinely be met.

## Follow the Harm, the Market, and the Foreign Hand

Behind a harm stand the traders, the foreign fleets, the dumpers, and the woodlands, fisheries, and land at stake. Trace who profits, what is harmed, and — importantly here — **what woodland, fishery, or land is threatened, what market buys it or what foreign fleet takes it, what international framework applies, and how the diaspora, the community, and the international bodies can act**. Two questions unlock most Somali efforts: **What is harmed, and what market or foreign hand drives it?** and **Which lever — the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, the frameworks — can meet it?** The charcoal, the fisheries, and the international frameworks are, together, the heart of most such efforts here. Everything else in a Somali effort ultimately serves these: the documentation exists to establish the harm and its market or foreign hand on the international record; the international-and-diaspora coalition exists to press that case through the world's bodies, the markets, and the maritime partners; and the international media exists to

reach the world's conscience and the markets with the story of the plundered woodlands and seas. Keep the charcoal, the fisheries, and the international frameworks at the centre of every case, appeal, and effort, and the effort retains a clear spine that runs from a single felled woodland or a single foreign trawler to the world's ban and the world's maritime frameworks, grounding the whole in the international channels through which a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state is genuinely reachable from outside.

## The Overseers

Finally, know the bodies and forces that shape a harm, because they are the levers. The **federal and state authorities and Somaliland's institutions**; the **international bodies and frameworks**; the **market and foreign actors**; the **diaspora and community**; and the **regional and international partners**. In Somalia, the **charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks** are the most distinctive levers. Each is a separate front, and a woodland felled, a foreign trawler fishing, waste dumped, or land degraded can genuinely be pressed — through the international frameworks, the markets, and the alternatives — though, honestly, the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered from abroad, the drought severe, the state fragile, and no victory final, and this guide will keep saying so, and keep working through the international, the diaspora, and the community, protecting anyone inside absolutely.

## QUICK REFERENCE: SUCCESS RATES

Before you commit effort, calibrate honestly — and here that means acknowledging the charcoal-and-conflict entanglement, the foreign plundering, and the fragile state, even as the international frameworks, the market pressure, the diaspora, and the alternatives give real, if partial, leverage. These figures are **directional, not guarantees** — patterns drawn from how such efforts tend to go for fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered states, not a controlled study. The decisive variables are whether the harm can be **tied to a charcoal market, a foreign fleet, or an international framework**, whether the **international and diaspora avenues** can be engaged, and whether **alternatives and community** can be built. Where the harm is documented and the international avenues used, the levers here are real; but temper every figure with the honest knowledge that the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered from abroad, and the state is fragile.

### Individual Step Success Rates

| Approach                          | Success Rate | Timeline     | Cost         | What "Success" Means                                    |
|-----------------------------------|--------------|--------------|--------------|---------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Documentation only</b>         | 15–25%       | weeks        | low          | Basis for every other step                              |
| <b>Charcoal / market-pressure</b> | 30–50%       | months–years | low          | The ban pressed, the markets and alternatives moved     |
| <b>Fisheries / anti-dumping</b>   | 30–50%       | years        | low–moderate | The foreign fishing and dumping pressed internationally |
| <b>Land / drought-adaptation</b>  | 35–55%       | years        | low–moderate | The land restored, alternatives to charcoal built       |
| <b>Coast / mangrove</b>           | 35–55%       | months–years | low          | The coast and mangroves conserved                       |
| <b>International / framework</b>  | 35–55%       | months–years | low          | The world's bodies and frameworks engaged               |

| Approach                    | Success Rate | Timeline     | Cost     | What "Success" Means                              |
|-----------------------------|--------------|--------------|----------|---------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Diaspora / community</b> | 35–55%       | months–years | low      | The diaspora and community mobilised              |
| <b>All levers together</b>  | 30–50%       | years        | moderate | Woodlands, fisheries, land defended, from outside |

**Key insight:** every step together beats any single one, and Somalia's real leverage is international, market-based, and community-borne: the **charcoal**, the **fisheries**, the **land**, the **coast**, and the **frameworks**. Its constraints are specific and honest: the charcoal **funds the conflict**, the sea is **plundered from abroad**, the drought **severe**, the state **fragile**, and no victory **final** — so progress comes through the international frameworks, the markets, the alternatives, the diaspora, and the community, protecting anyone inside, not through open confrontation.

*A note on cost and risk: most international levers here — an international appeal, a market pressure, an alternative-livelihood effort — are carried by international bodies, the diaspora, and partners, so the cost falls largely on them, not on those inside. But the risk to anyone inside is severe, for the charcoal trade is bound up with an armed insurgency and enforcement is dangerous, so the safety of the affected and of any local contact must come absolutely first, and the work must run from outside and through those who can act safely, clear of the contested and dangerous areas. The scarce resources are **the international and diaspora connections, the alternative-livelihood support, and careful documentation** — much of it reachable through the international bodies, the large diaspora, the market and maritime frameworks, and the humanitarian and climate partners.*

## Effectiveness Visualization

CHARCOAL + FISHERIES + LAND + COAST + FRAMEWORKS:

|                             |            |        |
|-----------------------------|------------|--------|
| Land / drought-adaptation:  | ■■■■■■■■■■ | 35-55% |
| Coast / mangrove:           | ■■■■■■■■■■ | 35-55% |
| International / framework:  | ■■■■■■■■■■ | 35-55% |
| Diaspora / community:       | ■■■■■■■■■■ | 35-55% |
| Charcoal / market-pressure: | ■■■■■■■■■■ | 30-50% |

CHARCOAL FUNDS CONFLICT / PLUNDERED SEA / FRAGILE STATE -- harder ground:

|                               |            |                         |
|-------------------------------|------------|-------------------------|
| Enforcement alone:            | ■■         | cannot succeed alone    |
| International & alternatives: | ■■■■■■■■■■ | the real path           |
| Woodlands & fisheries saved:  | ■■■■■■■■■■ | achievable in part      |
| The harm documented:          | ■■■■■■■■■■ | the reliable foundation |

**How to read this honestly.** The levers that most change outcomes in Somalia are **the land and drought-adaptation, the coast and mangrove conservation, the international frameworks, and the diaspora and community** — used together, with the charcoal and fisheries pressure alongside. The land, coast, and international levers show the ceiling: alternative livelihoods that break the charcoal cycle, coasts and mangroves conserved, and the world's frameworks engaged can achieve real, if partial, gains from outside. The charcoal-and-conflict entanglement and the fragile state show the honest floor: enforcement alone cannot succeed, and the work is external and slow. Most Somali efforts will sit between, and the honest lesson is that the levers here are real — able to defend the woodlands, fisheries, and land in part — but that enforcement alone cannot succeed, and the surest result is that the harm is documented and pressed through the international frameworks, the markets, and the alternatives.

## Step Importance Ranking (When All Combined)

1. **The land, drought-adaptation, and the alternatives** — Somalia's deepest need; breaking the desperate charcoal cycle.

2. **The international frameworks and the fisheries defence** — the world's bodies and the foreign harms they can reach.
3. **The charcoal and market pressure** — the ban and the markets that buy it.
4. **The coast, mangroves, and the diaspora** — the coastal conservation and the diaspora's voice.
5. **The documented harm and foreign hand** — the evidence that grounds it all.

## What These Campaigns Actually Show

A few honest patterns recur. **The charcoal is banned by the world** — a lever on the markets that buy it. **The foreign harms are reachable** — the international maritime frameworks can act. **The land needs alternatives** — breaking the charcoal cycle is the deepest work. **The diaspora is large and engaged** — a real channel. **But the charcoal funds the conflict and the state is fragile** — so the work is international, alternative-building, and careful. The through-line: **document the harm and the foreign or market hand; press the charcoal ban and its markets; press the foreign fishing and dumping internationally; restore the land and build alternatives to charcoal; conserve the coast and mangroves; use the international bodies, the diaspora, and the community; and protect anyone inside absolutely — because an effort that does can genuinely defend the woodlands, fisheries, and land from outside, while being honest that the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered from abroad, and no victory final.**

## STEP 1: TARGET IDENTIFICATION

Every effective effort begins by finding the exact harm — and the leverage, which here runs through the markets, the foreign fleets, and the international frameworks. Vague concern goes nowhere, and open confrontation is dangerous; an effort aimed at "this harm to this woodland, fishery, or land, driven by this market or foreign hand, which the international frameworks or alternatives can reach" is a real, workable effort. Answer five questions.

### The Five Core Questions

1. **What is harmed?** This is the first question here. What **woodland, fishery, or land** is harmed — the acacia woodlands, the coastal fisheries, the rangeland, the mangroves.
2. **What market or foreign hand drives it?** What **market or foreign actor** drives the harm — the charcoal markets abroad, the foreign fleets, the dumpers.
3. **Is it charcoal, fisheries, or land?** Whether the matter is one of the **charcoal trade**, the **fisheries and dumping**, or the **land and drought** — for each has its levers.
4. **What framework applies?** What **international ban, maritime, anti-dumping, or climate framework** the harm touches.
5. **How can the international, diaspora, and community act, safely?** How the **international bodies, the diaspora, and the community** can act — carefully, protecting anyone inside, clear of the contested areas.

### A Worked Example

Suppose the acacia woodlands are being felled for charcoal, shipped from a port to markets abroad, in an area where the trade is taxed by armed actors and enforcement is dangerous.



Working the five questions: **what is harmed? What market drives it? Is it charcoal, fisheries, or land? What framework applies?** And how can the international, diaspora, and community act, safely? The driver is the charcoal trade and the foreign markets, with the international ban, the market pressure, and the alternatives as the levers.

Within a season the effort has moved from "the woodlands are felled and the charcoal shipped and nothing can be said" to a real, careful effort: document the felling and the shipments and the markets; press the international ban and the foreign markets that buy it; build alternative fuels and livelihoods to break the cycle; and work through the international bodies and the diaspora — all protecting anyone inside absolutely and clear of the dangerous areas. That is a workable effort suited to Somalia — one that reaches a harm bound up with conflict through the international frameworks, the markets, and the alternatives, carefully. Notice what the five questions accomplish, and how they suit a fight in a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state: they turn what might seem an utterly hopeless situation — a broken state, a felled woodland, a plundered sea, a parched land, an armed insurgency profiting from the harm — into a set of specific, answerable questions, each attached to an international lever that reaches the harm from outside, where it is genuinely vulnerable, and where no one inside is endangered. The harm becomes a documentable felling, shipment, foreign catch, dumping, or degradation. The driver becomes a reachable market, foreign fleet, or dumper. The category becomes charcoal, fisheries, or land, each with its levers. The framework becomes the ban, the maritime rules, or the climate support. And the channels become the international bodies, the markets, the maritime partners, and the diaspora, protecting anyone inside. That translation — from a seemingly hopeless situation into a set of specific international actions that reach a fragile state's harms from outside while shielding everyone inside — is the first and most important thing a Somali effort does, because it moves the fight from the despair of a broken and conflict-ridden state onto the ground where the banned charcoal, the foreign fleets, and the world's support for the drought-stricken land are all genuinely reachable, and where careful, external, protective work can achieve real, if partial, defence of the woodlands, the seas, and the land.

## STEP 2: DOCUMENTATION — HOW TO BUILD AN UNASSAILABLE CASE

Documentation is the foundation everything else stands on — and here, distinctively, the decisive evidence is the harm and its market or foreign hand, much of it documented by international monitoring, satellite, and trade data. An international body, a market authority, a maritime framework, a partner, and the diaspora all move on evidence — and for Somalia, a clear record of the harm and the market or foreign hand behind it is precisely what an international effort turns into a real result, so build it well, and safely. Build your file in three layers.

### Layer 1: The Harm, the Market, and the Foreign Hand

Get the facts the case turns on. Identify the **harm** — the felling, the charcoal shipment, the foreign trawler, the dumping, the land degradation — and, decisively here, **the market or foreign hand behind it**: the charcoal markets abroad, the foreign fleets, the dumpers. Much of this is in the international monitoring, the satellite imagery, the trade and shipping data, and the maritime records. Establish exactly **what is harmed and what market or foreign hand drives it**, because the harm-and-its-driver is the case's foundation.

### Layer 2: The Harm, the Evidence, and the Scale



Document the harm with the evidence. Establish the **environmental harm** — the deforestation, the desertification, the fishery depletion, the contamination, the land degradation — and its **scale and driver** — drawing on **the international and satellite monitoring, the trade and shipping data, the maritime and scientific records, and, where entirely safe, local knowledge**. This harm-and-evidence record turns the concern into a documented case the international bodies, markets, and frameworks can act on.

### Layer 3: The Case, the Framework, the Channel, and the Protection

Finally, document the case and the path. Does the **harm** breach the international ban, the maritime rules, or the anti-dumping frameworks? What **international framework** applies? Which **international bodies, market authorities, or partners** will act? And how is **anyone inside protected absolutely**? Each is a separate element, and together they make a case the international channels can act on. This is the layer that most often decides these efforts, because a documented harm, a reachable market or foreign hand, an applicable framework, and an absolutely protected path are exactly what let a Somali effort defend the woodlands, fisheries, and land from outside. Build it well, and the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks become the effort's genuine strength. One practical note on building this layer: because Somalia's charcoal trade, illegal fishing, and drought have drawn sustained international attention — from the United Nations monitoring, from satellite mapping of the deforestation and the charcoal production, from the trade and shipping records, from the maritime and fisheries bodies, and from the climate and humanitarian agencies — a great deal of the necessary evidence already exists in the international public record, which spares an effort much of the burden of generating it and, crucially, keeps it on the safe ground of documentation gathered from outside. The felling of the woodlands and the charcoal production are mapped by satellite; the shipments and their markets are traced in the trade records; the foreign fishing is followed by the maritime monitoring; the drought and its toll are assessed by the humanitarian agencies. This means an effort can often build its file substantially from that existing international record, rather than seeking dangerous new evidence inside contested areas. Building this layer well therefore means seeking out and marshalling that existing record — the satellite and monitoring data, the trade and shipping records, the maritime and scientific assessments — and joining it, only where it is entirely safe, to any knowledge from inside, so that the case rests on a solid, largely-external, and internationally-verifiable foundation that never places anyone inside at risk.

## WHAT TO GATHER, AND WHERE TO FIND IT

Evidence in hand beats evidence you assume exists — and here much of it lives in the international monitoring, the satellite imagery, the trade and shipping data, and the maritime records, reachable from outside. Here is where the material tends to live in a Somali effort, and how to get it — with the **harm**, the **market or foreign hand**, the **evidence**, and the **framework** at the center, and the protection of anyone inside always first. Treat this as a checklist to work through, not a menu to admire.

### The Harm and Market-Hand Record

Start with the harm and its driver. **The international monitoring, the satellite imagery, and the trade and shipping data** establish the harm and its market or foreign hand; the distinctive strengths here are the **satellite record of deforestation and the trade record of the charcoal**, and the **maritime record of the foreign fleets**, all reachable internationally. Establish the **harm, its scale, and the market or foreign hand behind it**, drawing on the international and satellite record. Establish exactly **what is harmed and who drives it from the market or abroad**, because a harm tied to an identifiable market or foreign fleet is reachable from outside.

## The Charcoal, Fisheries, and Land Evidence

This is the heart of the file. Gather the **charcoal evidence** — the felling, the shipments, the markets, the ban — the **fisheries and dumping evidence** — the foreign fleets, the depletion, the waste — and the **land evidence** — the drought, the desertification, the degradation — drawing on **the international and satellite monitoring, the trade and maritime data, the scientific records, and, where entirely safe, local knowledge**. This harm-and-evidence record is what turns the concern into a documented case the international channels can act on.

## The Framework and International Record

Document the levers of the frameworks. Gather the record of **the international charcoal ban and its inspection frameworks; the maritime and fisheries and anti-dumping frameworks; the climate, drought, and humanitarian frameworks; and the market authorities that can reach the charcoal buyers**. A community and its allies that understand the ban, the maritime frameworks, and the markets hold the levers that reach a fragile state's harms from outside.

## The Diaspora, Community, and Partner Record

Document the wider levers. Gather the record of the **large Somali diaspora and their networks; the local communities and, in the north, Somaliland's own institutions; and the international, regional, and humanitarian partners**. A community and its allies joined to the diaspora, the safe local communities, and the international partners hold levers that reach a fragile state where its own enforcement cannot.

## The People, the Protection, and the Safety

Finally, and most importantly, map the human terrain and the absolute protection it requires. Who is affected — the **rural and pastoralist communities, the coastal fishers, the drought-stricken, and the future generations** — and who can act safely: the **international bodies, the diaspora, the safe local communities, and the partners**, since open action in contested areas is dangerous. And how does the effort **protect anyone inside absolutely, stay clear of the contested areas, and work through the international and the diaspora**? A Somali effort is advanced through the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks, from outside — so map that coalition deliberately, and let the absolute protection of anyone inside and the avoidance of the dangerous areas govern every single step.

## STEP 3: BUILDING LOCAL OPPOSITION

Here this step must be understood in a way unlike an open society, because Somalia is a fragile, conflict-affected state where an insurgency contests the countryside, open adversarial organising is dangerous, and the "opposition" that works is not open and domestic but international, diaspora-borne, and community-based where it is safe — with anyone inside protected absolutely. The task is to build a coalition — of international bodies, the diaspora, safe local communities, and partners — that defends the woodlands, fisheries, and land from outside, and builds the alternatives that break the desperate cycle.

## Why the International-Diaspora-and-Community Coalition Is Decisive

For Somalia, the "community" that can act is largely international, diaspora-borne, and — where safe — local, because a fragile, conflict-affected state cannot police its own harms, but the charcoal markets, the foreign fleets, and the drought can be reached through the world's frameworks, the diaspora, and the alternatives. That coalition supplies what an external effort runs on: the international bodies and frameworks

that reach the ban and the fleets, the large diaspora who can speak and support where those inside cannot, the safe local communities who hold knowledge and can build alternatives, and the partners who fund the adaptation. When the international bodies, the diaspora, and the safe communities act together, they become a genuine force. **A coalition that is international, diaspora-borne, and community-based here is not a weaker substitute for open civil society; it is the only safe and effective form advocacy can take for a fragile, conflict-affected state — the real foundation of an effort, defending the woodlands and fisheries and land from outside, while anyone inside is protected absolutely.** This is worth dwelling on, because the particular conditions of Somalia make this international, diaspora-borne, community-based approach not a fallback but the only responsible and effective one. In an open society, an effort rests on domestic mobilisation; in a fragile, conflict-affected state where an armed insurgency contests the countryside and profits from the very trade an effort would oppose, that avenue is both foreclosed and dangerous, and any attempt at open domestic confrontation risks grave harm to those inside. But Somalia's situation offers a different and genuine strength: the charcoal that drives the deforestation is banned by the world and reaches identifiable foreign markets that can be pressed; the fleets that plunder the sea and the waste dumped off the coast are foreign harms the world's maritime frameworks can reach; the drought that deepens the desperation calls for alternatives the climate and humanitarian frameworks support; and the large Somali diaspora can speak and organise freely abroad. The task, therefore, is to build the coalition that acts in that international and diaspora space, joined to the safe local communities: the international bodies and frameworks that reach the ban and the fleets, the diaspora who carry the voice and the support, the safe communities who build the alternatives, and the partners who fund them. This is not a weaker path but, for a fragile and conflict-affected state, the only safe and effective one, for it advances the defence of the woodlands and seas and land precisely where the conflict and the fragility cannot reach, while every person inside is protected absolutely.

## Finding the Coalition

Begin not with open domestic organising in contested areas, which is dangerous, but with those who can act safely — the **international bodies, the large diaspora, the safe local and coastal communities, Somaliland's institutions, and the partners** — and protect anyone inside absolutely, never exposing them. Widen to the international community that shares a concern for the charcoal, the fisheries, and the drought. Name the shared stake — **our woodlands, our seas, our land, and our children's future** — because the plundered woodlands and seas and the parched land are the shared loss of a people and a concern of the world. Frame the effort around the international frameworks, the alternatives, and the community, from outside. There is real power, and absolute necessity, in framing the cause this way, because it locates the entire effort in the one space where a fragile and conflict-affected state's harms are genuinely reachable and where no one inside is placed in danger. A cause framed as domestic confrontation would be both foreclosed and perilous, endangering those it means to help; a cause framed as the international enforcement of a world ban, the international defence of a plundered sea, and the building of alternatives to a desperate trade locates the effort among international bodies, world markets, maritime partners, and the diaspora, where the conflict's writ does not run and where the charcoal's illegality, the foreign fleets' reachability, and the drought's claim on the world's support are all genuinely in play. This framing is not only the only safe one; it is also the true one, because the charcoal really is banned and market-driven, the fishing and dumping really are foreign harms, and the drought really is a shared crisis calling for alternatives — so the international frame is not an evasion but an accurate location of where this fight can actually be waged. An effort that names this frame precisely — the international frameworks, the alternatives, and the community, from outside — stands on the only ground the Somali situation genuinely affords.

## Coalition-Building, Through the International and Community

A coalition allied is stronger than any single actor, and for Somalia it is built internationally, through the diaspora, and through safe communities. Reach to the **international bodies and frameworks**; the **large diaspora and their networks**; the **safe local and coastal communities**; the **market and maritime authorities**; and the **humanitarian, climate, and regional partners**. Frame the coalition around the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, and the coast. Build breadth internationally and through the diaspora and safe communities, and protect anyone inside absolutely — for the coalition's strength is precisely that it acts where the conflict and the fragility cannot reach.

## Sustaining the Effort

Somali efforts are sustained internationally, through the diaspora, and through safe communities. Keep the coalition **informed, connected, and coordinated**, and anyone inside **safe**; mark real steps — a shipment stopped, a fleet pressed, a woodland spared, an alternative built, a coast conserved. And keep the effort grounded in the international frameworks, the alternatives, and the community, which endure and reach a fragile state. The effort that lasts is the one that works internationally and through the diaspora and safe communities, engages the frameworks and the markets, builds the alternatives, and protects anyone inside absolutely.

## STEP 4: INTERNATIONAL, MARINE & ENVIRONMENTAL-GOVERNANCE CHALLENGES — THE CHARCOAL, THE FISHERIES, AND THE LAND

This is where a Somali effort is realistically advanced — not through open civil society, which is dangerous, but through the **international pressing of the charcoal and its markets, the defence of the fisheries from the foreign fleets and dumping, and the restoration of the land through adaptation and alternatives**, pursued from outside through the world's frameworks, the diaspora, and the safe communities. Here the charcoal, fisheries, and land levers come together, because for Somalia a harm can be reached through the markets, the maritime frameworks, and the alternatives, from outside.

## Setting Expectations Honestly

First, the honest truth. The levers are **real but international, indirect, slow, and partial**. The charcoal pressure is **real through the ban and markets but the trade is entrenched and conflict-funding**; the fisheries defence is **reachable internationally but the state cannot yet patrol its waters**; the land restoration is **fundable but the drought is severe and the cycle desperate**; and no domestic enforcement is **yet reliable**. What these levers realistically achieve is **the charcoal ban pressed and markets moved, the foreign fishing and dumping raised internationally, the land restored and alternatives built, the coast conserved, and the frameworks engaged** — real, if partial, outcomes from outside, not the immediate end of harms bound up with conflict and a plundered sea. Enter this front clear-eyed: the charcoal, the fisheries, and the land are Somalia's distinctive levers, strongest when the **harm and its market or foreign hand are clearly documented and reachable abroad** — but the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered, and the drought severe.

## The Charcoal and the Markets

The first front is the charcoal and the markets that buy it. The **felling of the acacia woodlands for charcoal**, the main driver of deforestation and a taxed revenue for the insurgency, banned by the world yet

continuing, can be pressed through the **international ban and its inspection frameworks, the pressure on the foreign markets that buy the charcoal, and — most importantly — the alternative fuels, livelihoods, and reforestation that can break the desperate cycle** at its root. Use the charcoal and the markets, because the trade is banned by the world and reaches identifiable foreign buyers who can be pressed, and because the desperation that drives the felling can only be broken by the alternatives that give impoverished people another way to live — so enforcement of the ban must be joined to the alternatives, or it will fail as it has before. It is worth being clear about both the power and the limits of this charcoal front, honestly, for it is the most distinctive lever a Somali effort holds. Its power is real: the trade is banned by the world, its production and shipments are traceable, and its markets abroad are identifiable and can be pressed to close to it, striking at both the deforestation and the revenue it provides to armed actors. Its limits are equally real, and the history of the ban proves them: enforcement alone has repeatedly failed, because the trade is driven by desperate people with few alternatives, taxed by armed actors who profit from it, and pulled by lucrative foreign markets that keep buying, so that a ban unaccompanied by alternatives and by market closure has only pushed the trade into smuggling. Understanding both means using the charcoal front for what it does best — pressing the world's ban, alerting and closing the foreign markets, and, above all, building the alternative fuels, livelihoods, and reforestation that address the desperation at the trade's root — while recognising that enforcement and alternatives must go together, for neither alone has succeeded, and that the whole must be pursued from outside and with care for the danger the trade carries.

## **The Fisheries and the Dumping**

The second front is the sea. The **illegal foreign fishing that has plundered the coast and the toxic waste dumped off it**, exploiting a state that could not defend its waters, can be pressed through the **international maritime, fisheries, and anti-dumping frameworks** — the monitoring and surveillance, the cooperation of European and regional partners, the model of the international cooperation that once curbed the piracy off the same coast, and the slow rebuilding of the state's own enforcement and the coastal communities' rights. Use the fisheries and the dumping, because the foreign fleets and the dumpers are reachable through the world's maritime frameworks and the partners who patrol these waters, and because the injuries done to the coastal communities are a matter of international justice the world has reason to address.

## **The Land and the Drought**

The third front is the land. The **recurrent drought, the desertification, and the degradation** that parch the land and drive desperate people into the charcoal trade can be met through **adaptation, restoration, sustainable rangeland management, alternative livelihoods, and the climate and humanitarian frameworks** — the restoration of the woodlands and rangelands, the water and drought preparedness, and the alternatives that break the charcoal cycle. Press the land and the drought, because restoring the land and building alternatives to charcoal is the deepest and most lasting work here, addressing at its root the desperation that fuels the deforestation, and because the climate and humanitarian frameworks genuinely support it. Pursued together — the charcoal, the fisheries, and the land — these fronts are how a Somali effort defends the woodlands, the fisheries, and the land, from outside, through the world's frameworks, the markets, the alternatives, and the diaspora, protecting anyone inside absolutely. It is worth understanding why these fronts reinforce one another so well in Somalia's particular situation. The charcoal front presses a banned, market-driven trade at its foreign buyers and, at its root, through the alternatives that give desperate people another way to live. The fisheries front reaches the foreign fleets and the dumpers through the world's maritime frameworks and the partners who patrol the waters. And the land front restores the woodlands and rangelands and eases the drought that drives the whole desperate cycle. Each covers the

others' reach: the charcoal at the level of the world's markets, the fisheries at the level of the world's maritime frameworks, and the land at the level of the world's climate and humanitarian support. And each strengthens the others, for the alternatives that restore the land are the same that break the charcoal cycle, the drought that parches the land is what drives the felling, and the international attention that reaches the charcoal reaches the plundered sea as well. An effort that grasps this mutual reinforcement, and pursues each front together from outside, makes the fullest use of the several international levers that reach a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state, while every person inside is protected absolutely.

## TURNING YOUR EVIDENCE INTO ARGUMENTS

Evidence does not speak for itself; you must aim it at each decider in the language that moves them. The same file of harm and its market or foreign hand becomes different arguments for the international bodies, the market authorities, the maritime frameworks, the climate and humanitarian partners, and the diaspora. Translate deliberately, and always from outside, protecting anyone inside.

### For the International Bodies

The international bodies respond to **the ban, the frameworks, and the harm's international dimension**. Frame the harm as a breach of the ban or a matter for the frameworks: here is the charcoal shipment, the ban it flouts, the conflict-funding and environmental crime it feeds. Give them the documented harm and its international dimension, and press for enforcement and action. An international body charged with the ban and the frameworks can act where the state cannot.

### For the Market Authorities

The market authorities respond to **the illegal trade reaching their markets**. Frame the harm as an illegal, banned trade entering their markets: here is the charcoal, banned by the world, reaching your ports and buyers. Give them the trade and shipping evidence, and press for the closing of their markets to the banned charcoal. A market that closes to the banned charcoal strikes at the trade's root.

### For the Maritime and Anti-Dumping Frameworks

The maritime and anti-dumping frameworks respond to **the foreign harms in the waters**. Frame the harm as illegal foreign fishing or dumping: here is the foreign fleet, the depletion, the waste, the frameworks they breach. Give them the maritime and monitoring evidence, and press for surveillance, enforcement, and cooperation. The world's maritime frameworks and the partners who patrol these waters can reach the foreign harms.

### For the Climate, Humanitarian Partners, and Diaspora

The climate and humanitarian partners and the diaspora respond to **the drought, the alternatives, and the people**. Translate the file into the story of a land parched and a people driven to desperation: here is the drought, the desperation, the alternatives that can break the cycle. Frame it as the restoration of the land and the building of alternatives. Keep it accurate and careful; and protect anyone inside absolutely. And speak to the world's conscience and the diaspora's commitment.

### The Golden Rule

Never fabricate, never exaggerate, work from outside, and protect anyone inside absolutely. Your credibility rests on the real, documented harm and its real market or foreign hand — international frameworks, market pressure, and alternatives, pursued from outside; and the safety of anyone inside is paramount, for the



conflict is real and the trade dangerous. State the harm precisely, tie it to the ban, the maritime frameworks, or the drought, and press through the international bodies, the markets, and the partners. An effort that is precise, documented, and international is far harder to dismiss than one that overreaches, and far safer than any that would expose someone inside a conflict-affected state.

## STEP 5: MEDIA STRATEGY

Media and attention convert your evidence into pressure — and here, for a fragile and conflict-affected state, the domestic space is dangerous and any domestic voice endangered, so the "media" that works is the international coverage and the diaspora's voice that reach the world's conscience and the markets. The story — the woodlands felled and the seas plundered and the land parched — resonates internationally, if told carefully and from outside.

### Why Media Matters

The international bodies, the market authorities, the maritime frameworks, and the world behave differently when the harm and its foreign or market hand are visible internationally. Media does three things here: it **connects the international community to the evidence**, it **raises the stakes** for the markets that buy the charcoal and the fleets that plunder the sea, and it **reaches the frameworks, the partners, and the diaspora**. But the domestic space is dangerous and any domestic voice endangered, so the media effort runs entirely through **international coverage, the diaspora's voice, and careful, strictly-environmental documentation**, protecting anyone inside absolutely, never through anything that could endanger a person in a contested area.

### Crafting Your Narrative

Lead with the plunder and the desperation. The strongest frame is concrete and international: *the acacia woodlands are felled for charcoal that funds conflict and feeds foreign markets, the seas are plundered by foreign fleets and poisoned by dumped waste, and the land is parched — and the world's frameworks, markets, and conscience can reach what a broken state cannot*. Put the plundered woodlands and seas and the parched land first, because the injustice and the plunder are genuine and resonant internationally. Keep it scrupulously accurate; and never expose anyone inside. The Somali story is powerful internationally precisely because the charcoal is banned, the fleets foreign, the dumping a documented injustice, and the drought a shared crisis.

### Choosing Your Channels

Match the channel to the audience, all international. **International coverage and the diaspora's voice** for the world and the markets; **the frameworks' and partners' channels** for the ban and the fleets; **the humanitarian and climate channels** for the drought and the alternatives; and **careful documentation** for the record. Because the domestic space is dangerous, the international channels are the only ones, and the safety of anyone inside comes absolutely first — the banned charcoal, the plundered seas, and the parched land are the story's international power.

### A Few Cautions

Stay accurate, careful, international, and protective — the aim is defending the woodlands and fisheries and land from outside, not exaggeration, and never anything that could expose or endanger anyone inside. Frame the story around the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, and the alternatives, and handle the conflict, the armed actors, the clans, Somaliland, and the geopolitics factually and from the safety of outside. Handle the



sensitive matters through the documented international record, never through anything that could endanger a person inside a contested area. And sustain the story across the slow international work. Above all, let the banned charcoal, the plundered seas, and the parched land carry the story, because that is where a Somali effort is strongest and safest.

## **EMAILS & LETTERS: TEMPLATES THAT WORK**

Templates save time and prevent mistakes, but adapt every one — insert the real harm and its market or foreign hand, keep it factual, work from outside, and protect anyone inside absolutely. Here the international frameworks, the markets, and the documented record win. These are addressed to international bodies, not to those in contested areas.

### **8A: To an International Body (the Charcoal Ban)**

**Subject: The banned charcoal trade and its harm in Somalia**

To [international body / sanctions monitor],

The felling of Somalia's acacia woodlands for charcoal, banned by the world, continues, driving deforestation and desertification and funding armed actors. We respectfully urge enforcement of the ban, inspection of the shipments, and pressure on the markets that buy the charcoal. We attach the satellite and trade evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

### **8B: To a Market or Import Authority**

**Subject: Banned Somali charcoal reaching your markets**

To [import / market authority],

Charcoal from Somalia, banned by the United Nations, may be reaching your markets and buyers. We respectfully urge that your markets be closed to this banned charcoal, whose trade drives deforestation and funds conflict. We attach the trade and shipping evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

### **8C: To a Maritime or Fisheries Framework**

**Subject: Illegal foreign fishing off the Somali coast**

To [maritime / fisheries body],

Foreign fleets are illegally fishing off the Somali coast, depleting the fisheries a coastal people depend on, exploiting a state that cannot yet patrol its waters. We respectfully urge monitoring, surveillance, and enforcement through the maritime and fisheries frameworks and the partners who patrol these waters. We attach the maritime evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

## **8D: To an Anti-Dumping Framework**

**Subject: Toxic and hazardous waste dumped off the Somali coast**

To [environmental / anti-dumping body],

Hazardous and toxic waste has been dumped off the Somali coast, poisoning the sea and the coastal communities. We respectfully urge investigation and action through the anti-dumping and environmental frameworks, and cooperation with the partners who can reach it. We attach the available evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

## **8E: To a Climate or Humanitarian Partner**

**Subject: Drought, the land, and alternatives to charcoal in Somalia**

To [climate / humanitarian partner],

Recurrent drought is parching Somalia's land and driving desperate people into the charcoal trade that worsens it. We respectfully urge support for land restoration, drought preparedness, and the alternative fuels and livelihoods that can break this cycle. We attach the assessment.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

## **8F: To a Coastal-Conservation or Regional Partner**

**Subject: Defending the Somali coast and its mangroves**

To [conservation / regional partner],

The Somali coast and its mangroves face degradation alongside the illegal fishing and dumping. We respectfully urge support for coastal and mangrove conservation and community-based management, in keeping with the regional and marine frameworks. We attach the coastal evidence.

Respectfully,

[Name / organisation, contact]

## **8G: To the Diaspora and Solidarity Networks**

**Subject: Our woodlands, our seas — from outside**

Dear friends,

Our woodlands are felled for charcoal, our seas plundered and poisoned, our land parched — and though it is dangerous to act at home, we can act from outside, through the world's frameworks, markets, and conscience, and through the alternatives that give our people another way to live. Together, in the diaspora and with international allies, we can defend our land and seas. Please join us, with absolute care for anyone inside.

With respect,

[Name / organisation]

## 8H: To the International Community

**Subject: Reaching a fragile state's harms through the world's frameworks**

Dear [partners / community],

Somalia's woodlands, seas, and land are harmed by a banned charcoal trade, foreign fleets, dumped waste, and drought — and though the state cannot yet defend them, the world's frameworks, markets, and partners can reach these harms from outside. Together — international bodies, markets, maritime and climate partners, and the diaspora — by documenting the harm and pressing the international channels and the alternatives, we can defend the land and seas. Please join us, protecting anyone inside absolutely.

With respect,

[Name / organisation]

## IF YOU HAVE LITTLE TIME: THE RAPID-FIRE VERSION

Sometimes a harm is acute — a charcoal shipment loading, a foreign fleet fishing, waste being dumped, a woodland felled — and you cannot run the full effort. Triage to the international levers that work fastest and most safely here, which means the international bodies, the market authorities, and the maritime frameworks, protecting anyone inside absolutely.

### The First 48 Hours

Establish the essentials: **what is harmed, and what market or foreign hand drives it**. Identify the immediate harm — **a charcoal shipment, a foreign fleet, a dumping, a felling** — because that is what you must affect first. Reach the **international bodies, the market or maritime authorities, and the diaspora** at once, because for Somalia the international frameworks, the markets, and the maritime partners are the fastest routes to real leverage — and protect anyone inside absolutely from the start, for the conflict is real.

### The Fastest-Moving Levers

Some levers work faster than others. **An international ban-enforcement or shipment alert** can move at once against a charcoal shipment. **A maritime alert** can be raised quickly against a foreign fleet. **A market alert** can be raised where the charcoal is landing. **The diaspora** can mobilise quickly. These outpace the slower work of the deep restoration and the alternatives — which must follow — because the international bodies, the markets, and the maritime frameworks can be brought to bear immediately. Above all, if a banned charcoal shipment is loading or a foreign fleet is fishing, alert the international ban-enforcement and maritime frameworks fast, because a world ban and the partners who patrol these waters are the quickest reach.

### Emergency Coalition-Building

You cannot build a full coalition overnight, but for Somalia you can reach the international allies fast, and safely. Reach immediately to the **international bodies, the market and maritime authorities, and the diaspora**, protecting anyone inside absolutely. A coalition documenting the harm and engaging the international channels is the most a rapid Somali effort can do, from outside. Speed favours the prepared: know the harm, the market or foreign hand, and the international channels before the crisis breaks, and work from outside, protecting all inside.

## WHEN THE SYSTEM IS TILTED

Here, honestly, the field is tilted about as far as any in this series, by a conflict in which an armed insurgency contests the countryside and profits from the charcoal, by a plundering of the sea that a weak state cannot stop, by a drought that deepens the desperation, and by a fragile and factional state whose enforcement is weak. Name it plainly, because pretending the state can enforce, or that the charcoal is not conflict-funding, or that the sea is not plundered, would be false — but the world's ban, the maritime frameworks, the markets, the alternatives, and the diaspora make even this deeply tilted field one where careful, external work can reach.

### Recognising a Tilted Field

The signs are specific and honest. **An insurgency contests the countryside** — and profits from the charcoal. **The sea is plundered from abroad** — and the state cannot stop it. **The drought deepens the desperation** — driving people to the charcoal. **And the state is fragile and factional** — its enforcement weak. But **the world's ban, the maritime frameworks, the markets, the alternatives, and the diaspora** can be reached. This is a tilt about as steep as any, worked from outside through the international frameworks, the markets, the alternatives, and the diaspora, protecting anyone inside, not through open confrontation.

### Strategies for a Tilted Field

When the field is this tilted, use the international levers, from outside. Lean on the **world's charcoal ban and the markets** that buy it; the **maritime frameworks and the partners** who patrol the waters; the **climate and humanitarian frameworks** that fund the land's restoration; the **alternatives** that break the desperate cycle; and the **diaspora**, which acts where those inside cannot. Meet the entangled harms not with domestic confrontation but with the international pressure on the markets and fleets and the alternatives that address the desperation at its root. And build the international relationships and the alternatives over time, because for a fragile state these accumulate into external pressure and lasting change. A field tilted this far is worked from outside through the world's frameworks, markets, and conscience and the alternatives that break the cycle, protecting anyone inside absolutely, not through a domestic confrontation the conflict makes impossible.

### The Honest Possibility of Losing

You may achieve little visible change — the charcoal may ship, the fleets may fish, the waste may be dumped, the land may parch — and this guide will not pretend otherwise; the tilt is among the steepest and the state fragile. But even here the work is rarely wholly wasted: the **harm was documented, the ban pressed, the markets alerted, the fleets raised, the alternatives built, and the world engaged** — and every shipment stopped, every market closed, every fleet pressed, every woodland spared, every alternative built makes a real difference and builds the international pressure and the lasting alternatives a fragile state's harms cannot forever escape. Press, from outside and carefully, for the woodlands and the seas and the land; even if a harm continues, the record you built and the alternatives you seeded will shape what comes, because the plundered woodlands and seas and the desperate cycle are matters the international community can, in time, reach.

## WHEN IT'S ACTUAL CORRUPTION — AND WHO BENEFITS

In Somalia, alongside the honest tilt of a conflict-affected state, there is a real dimension of capture, because the charcoal trade profits armed actors, complicit officials, and traders alike, the foreign fishing has been enabled by dubious licences and complicity, and the port and trade revenues have too often served the powerful rather than the public or the environment. The harm here is partly the capture of the woodlands, the fisheries, and their revenues by those who profit from the plunder. The response, encouragingly, runs through genuinely international channels — the world's ban and sanctions frameworks, the maritime and market frameworks, and the transparency they can compel.

## Telling Capture from the Ordinary Tilt

Here the capture is bound up with a conflict and a plundered sea, and its marks are specific: **the charcoal profiting armed actors and complicit officials, the foreign fishing enabled by dubious licences and complicity, the port and trade revenues serving the powerful, and the woodlands and fisheries plundered for private and armed gain**. The task is to document it rigorously for the international channels and reach it through the ban, the markets, and the maritime frameworks, relying on the international monitoring, the trade and shipping data, and the maritime records, and keeping strictly to the environmental. And note that the capture of the woodlands and fisheries is inseparable from the harm to them, for the plunder that profits the powerful is the same that fells the woodlands and empties the seas.

## Responding to Capture — Through the International Channels

Where the capture is real, the response runs through the international channels that can reach it. Use the **world's ban and sanctions frameworks** to press the charcoal and those who profit from it. Use the **market frameworks** to close the buyers to the banned trade. Use the **maritime frameworks** to reach the foreign fishing and the dubious licences. Use the **international monitoring and transparency** to expose the capture. And use the **diaspora and the world's media** to document it. Document rigorously and protect anyone inside absolutely, for in a conflict-affected state the record must be international and the people shielded. Route the effort through the ban, the markets, the maritime frameworks, and the transparency — never through domestic confrontation, which is dangerous.

## A Note on Safety and Protection

This note matters greatly here, and governs everything. Somalia is a fragile, conflict-affected state where an armed insurgency contests the countryside, the charcoal trade is dangerous, and environmental work carries real risk, so this work must be done from outside and must protect anyone inside absolutely. Work through the **international, diaspora, and — only where entirely safe — community channels**; never expose or endanger anyone inside, and treat their safety and the avoidance of the contested and dangerous areas as the first and overriding consideration; frame the work as international environmental action, pursued from outside; and handle the conflict, the armed actors, the clans, Somaliland, and the geopolitics only through the documented international record, never through anything that could endanger a person inside. Protection here is not one concern among others but the governing rule: the effective and safe path for Somalia runs through the international channels, the markets, the alternatives, and the diaspora, from outside, and nothing — no documentation, no exposure, no appeal — is worth endangering a single person inside a conflict-affected state.

## INTEGRATION & TIMELINE: RUNNING ALL FIVE STEPS TOGETHER

The steps in this guide are written in sequence but run in parallel, each feeding the others — all international, diaspora-borne, community-based where safe, and protective of anyone inside. Here is how they fit into a single Somali effort.

## The Parallel Effort

From the start, the five run together. **Documentation** builds the harm-and-driver file. **Target identification** aims it at the international levers. **Local opposition**, understood as the international-diaspora-and-community coalition, organises the international bodies, the diaspora, the safe communities, and the partners. **International, marine, and environmental-governance** work presses the charcoal and markets, defends the fisheries, and restores the land. **Media**, entirely international, carries the plunder-and-alternatives cause. The harm-and-driver feeds all five at once — a documented case is a ban-enforcement effort, a market pressure, a maritime appeal, and an alternative-livelihood effort together. Run in parallel, they compound; run one at a time, they stall — and here, working from outside, they compound into real, if partial, defence of the woodlands, fisheries, and land.

## A Rough Timeline

**Early (weeks 1–8):** establish the harm and its market or foreign hand; identify the ban, the maritime frameworks, the markets, and the alternatives; build the international-diaspora coalition and begin documentation, protecting anyone inside. **Middle (months–years):** press the charcoal ban and its markets; defend the fisheries and raise the dumping; restore the land and build alternatives; and conserve the coast. **Later (years):** see shipments stopped, markets closed, fleets pressed, woodlands spared, alternatives built, and the coast conserved. A Somali effort works from outside, and its fruits — woodlands and fisheries and land defended — are slow and partial; pace it accordingly, and let the absolute protection of anyone inside govern every step.

## The Core Discipline

Through it all, hold the discipline that gives these efforts their force: **document the harm and the market or foreign hand; press the charcoal ban and its markets; press the foreign fishing and dumping internationally; restore the land and build alternatives to charcoal; conserve the coast and mangroves; use the international bodies, the diaspora, and the community; and protect anyone inside absolutely.** The coalition that presses all five, from outside, and protects anyone inside, is the one that can genuinely defend the woodlands, fisheries, and land — the kind of result a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state allows, from outside.

## FINAL ASSESSMENT

Opposing a destructive harm in Somalia is genuinely difficult, and bound up with a conflict in which an insurgency contests the countryside and profits from the charcoal, with a plundering of the sea a weak state cannot stop, with a drought that deepens the desperation, and with a fragile and factional state, and this guide has been honest about that from its first line: the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered from abroad, the drought severe, the state fragile, and no victory final. And yet the effort is far from futile, because the charcoal is banned by the world and reaches identifiable markets, because the illegal fishing and the dumping are foreign harms the international frameworks can reach, because the drought demands alternatives the world supports, because the coast can be defended, and because the international bodies, the diaspora, and the rebuilding state offer real channels — and those levers of the charcoal, the fisheries, the land, the coast, and the frameworks are real.



Some honest truths hold across every effort here. **The charcoal is banned by the world, and its markets and the alternatives can be pressed. The foreign fishing and dumping are reachable through the world's maritime frameworks. The land needs alternatives, and the climate and humanitarian frameworks support them. But the charcoal funds the conflict, the sea is plundered, and the state is fragile, and the work is international, slow, and partial.** Hold both truths at once: real, distinctive levers of international frameworks and alternatives, and the honest weight of a conflict-affected and plundered state.

Above all, keep the discipline — and the protection — that give these efforts their force. Document the harm and the market or foreign hand. Press the charcoal ban and its markets. Press the foreign fishing and dumping internationally. Restore the land and build alternatives to charcoal. Conserve the coast and mangroves. Use the international bodies, the diaspora, and the community. And protect anyone inside absolutely — because for a fragile, conflict-affected, resource-plundered state, an effort that defends the woodlands and fisheries and land from outside, through the world's frameworks, markets, and conscience and the alternatives that break the cycle, and that shields every person inside, is the one that is both effective and just.

Somalia is a Horn of Africa land of acacia woodlands and a long, once-rich coast, worn by decades of conflict and drought — its woodlands felled for a charcoal that funds war and feeds foreign markets, its seas plundered by foreign fleets and poisoned by dumped waste, its land parched and its people driven by desperation into the very trade that deepens their loss. This guide has hidden none of that, nor pretended that the state can yet defend its woodlands and seas, or that the charcoal is simple, or that the drought can be quickly undone, and there is no landmark victory to promise you. But the charcoal is banned by the world, and there its markets can be pressed and its cycle broken by alternatives; the foreign fishing and the dumping are harms the world's maritime frameworks can reach; and the land can be restored and the desperation eased with the world's support. Those are the levers, and they are real: the world's ban and the markets that must close to the charcoal, the maritime frameworks and the partners who patrol these waters, the climate and humanitarian frameworks that restore the land, and the large diaspora and the world's conscience that reach a fragile state from outside. There is no enforcement the state can yet reliably deliver, and no quick end to harms bound up with conflict and a plundered sea; this guide has said so throughout, and insisted above all on the absolute protection of anyone inside. But the woodlands and seas and land of Somalia are worth every careful, international effort, the levers that run through the world's frameworks and the alternatives are real, and the patient, external, protective work of documenting the harm, pressing the ban and the fleets, and building the alternatives is one that the international community, the large diaspora, and the safe communities can genuinely do — and, from outside and with care, help a worn and resilient land begin to defend its woodlands and its seas. So can you.